

Google launches new programme to improve open source documentation

Google has launched the Season of Docs, a new programme to improve documentation for open source projects.

This programme aims to bring together open source contributors and technical writers, to create stronger and more comprehensive documentation for various open source technologies.



The Open Source Survey had demonstrated that good documentation is lacking for many open source projects. Google believes that this is because creation of documentation is hard, and so it created this programme to improve it.

An extract from a Google blog reads, “During Season of Docs, technical writers will spend a few months working closely with open source communities. Each writer works with their chosen open source project. The writers bring their expertise to the projects’ documentation while at the same time learning about open source and new technologies.”

Mentors from participating open source organisations will share knowledge of their communities’ processes and tools. Together, the technical writers and mentors will work to create a new doc set, improve the structure of the existing docs, develop a much-needed tutorial, or improve contribution processes and guides.

Google has prepared a timeline for the programme. Mentoring organisations can submit applications starting April 2019 and technical writers from May 2019.

The programme is to be executed in phases:

- April 2-23: Open source organisations apply to take part in Season of Docs.
- April 30: Google publishes the list of accepted mentoring organisations, along with their ideas for documentation projects.
- April 30 – June 28: Technical writers choose the project they’d like to work on and submit their proposals to Season of Docs.
- July 30: Google announces the accepted technical writer projects.
- August 1 – September 1: Community bonding: Technical writers get to know mentors and the open source community, and refine their projects in collaboration with their mentors.

Red Hat releases Quarkus, a Kubernetes native Java framework

Red Hat has released Quarkus, a Kubernetes native Java framework tailored for GraalVM and OpenJDK HotSpot. Quarkus aims to make Java a leading platform in Kubernetes and in serverless environments, offering developers a unified reactive and imperative programming model to optimally address a wider range of distributed application architectures.

Quarkus offers a full-stack framework by leveraging a series of libraries used by Java developers, including Eclipse MicroProfile, JPA/Hibernate, JAX-RS/RESTEasy, Eclipse Vert.x, Netty and more.

Quarkus also includes an extension framework that third-party framework authors can leverage to extend it. This extension framework reduces the complexity of making third-party frameworks run on Quarkus and compile to a GraalVM native binary.

Based on Red Hat testing, Quarkus delivers significant runtime efficiencies such as a fast startup enabling automatic scaling up/down of microservices on containers and Kubernetes, low memory utilisation that helps to optimise container density in microservices architecture deployments, and a smaller application and container image footprint.

According to Red Hat, Quarkus is designed to seamlessly bring both imperative and reactive programming models onto the same platform for microservices development.

“Quarkus provides an effective solution for running Java in this new world of serverless environments, with microservices, containers, Kubernetes, FaaS, and the cloud because it has been designed with these in mind,” Jason Greene, Quarkus project co-founder and distinguished engineer at Red Hat, wrote in a blog.